

ART & CULTURE



INDIAN ARCHITECTURE

MODULE - 23

**ARCHITECTURE OF
MUGHALS**

MUGHAL ARCHITECTURE

The Mughals were great patrons of art and architecture. Under them, architecture regained its place of importance, as new buildings were built with great vision and artistic inspiration.

1 BABUR



KABULI BAGH MOSQUE, PANIPAT

- 1 Babur undertook the construction of mosques in Panipat and Rohilkhand, both constructed in 1526 A.D.
- 2 However, his reign was too short-lived to inspire any new style or technique.
- 3 There were some prominent mosques which include those at Panipat and Sambhal in Rohilkhand.

MUGHAL ARCHITECTURE

2

HUMAYUN



CITY OF DINPANAH

- 1 Humayun's reign was marked with constant power struggle with Sher Shah Suri.
- 2 So, he couldn't focus much on art and architecture.
- 3 He laid the foundation of a city named Dinpanah, but couldn't finish it.
- 4 Persian style became prominent in the architecture of this period.

MUGHAL ARCHITECTURE

3 SHER SHAH



QILA-I-KUHNA MOSQUE

- 1 During his reign, Sher Shah undertook the construction of Quila-e-Quhunah mosque.
- 2 He also undertook the construction of Grand Trunk Road and his tomb at Sasaram.
- 3 The constructions under Sher Shah continued the traditions of the Delhi Sultanate period.
- 4 After Akbar ascended the throne of Delhi in 1556, the golden period of Mughal art and architecture started.

MUGHAL ARCHITECTURE

4

AKBAR



TUDOR ARCH

- 1 Akbar took a keen interest in the development of art and architecture during his reign.
- 2 The principal feature of the constructions during Akbar's reign was the use of red sandstone .
- 3 He also introduced the use of 'Tudor arch' (four centred arch).
- 4 Some of the prominent construction works undertaken during Akbar's reign are described below:

MUGHAL ARCHITECTURE

4

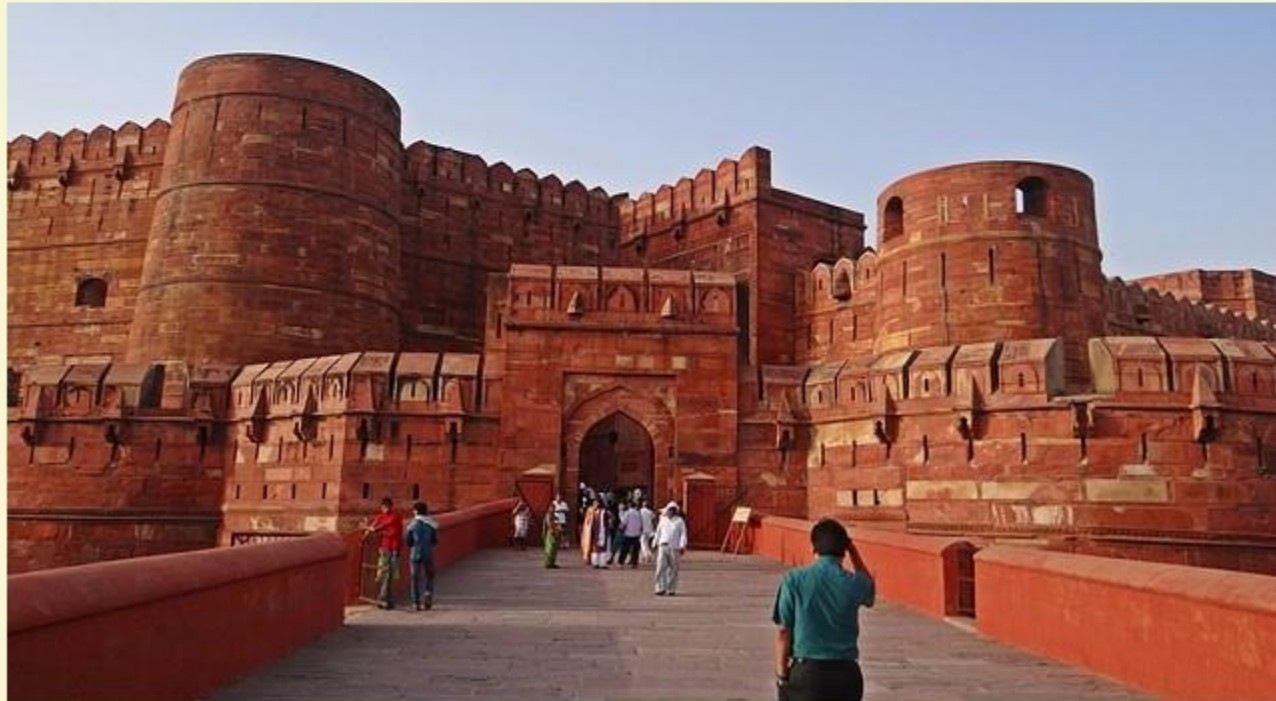
AKBAR

1

AGRA FORT

1 It was one of the first constructions started during the reign of Akbar.

2 However, most of the structures present inside the fort were done during the reign of Shah Jahan.



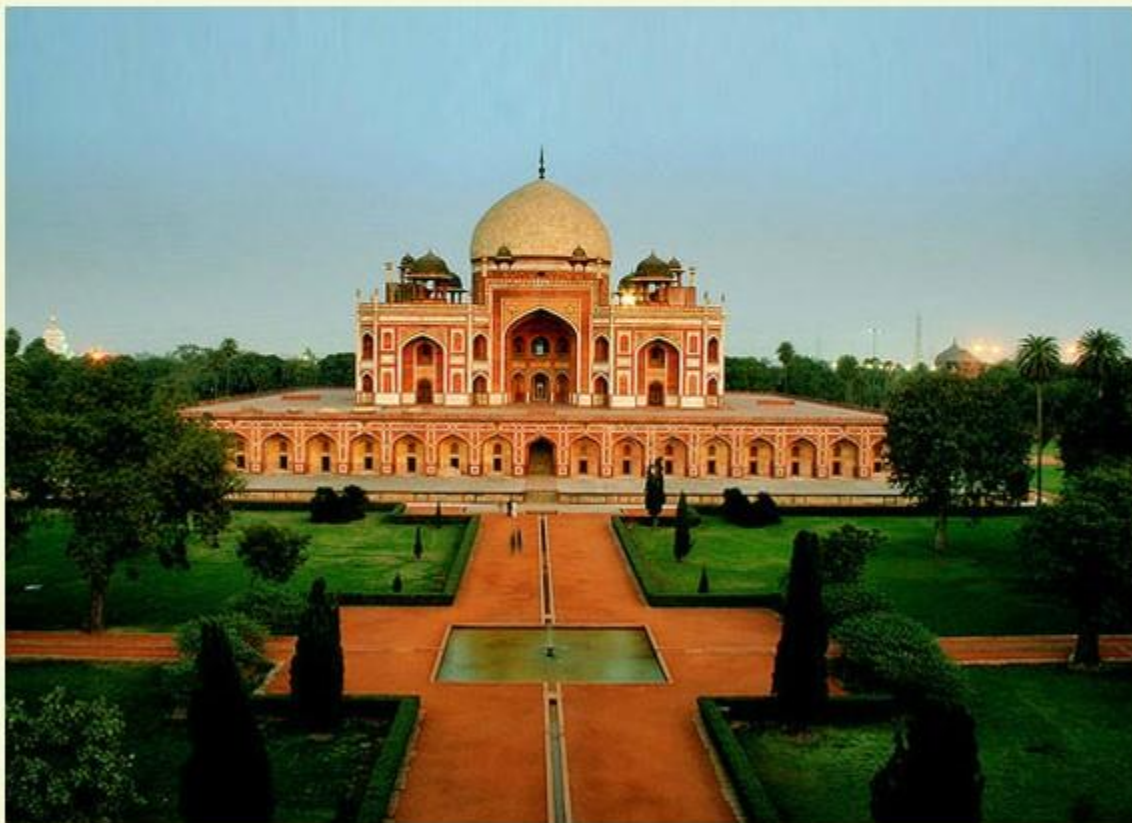
MUGHAL ARCHITECTURE

4

AKBAR

1

AGRA FORT



CHARBAGH STYLE

3

Some of the prominent buildings here are:

- **Moti Masjid**, made by Shah Jahan.
- **Diwan-i-aam** (Hall of Public audience) by Shahjahan.
- **Diwan-i-khas** (Hall of Private audience) by Shahjahan.
- **Jahangiri Mahal**
- **Sheesh Mahal** (Turkish Bath).

4

The gardens inside the fort are built using the **Charbagh style**. During the reign of Akbar, more than 5000 women stayed in his harem inside this fort.



MOTI MASJID



**JAHANGIRI
MAHAL**

MUGHAL ARCHITECTURE

4

AKBAR

2

FATEHPUR SIKRI



FATEHPUR SIKRI

1

One of the highlights of Indo-Islamic architecture was the creation of a new capital city by Akbar at Fatehpur Sikri.

2

It has been described as a “frozen moment in history” as the buildings here represent a unique blend of Hindu and Persian styles.

MUGHAL ARCHITECTURE

4

AKBAR

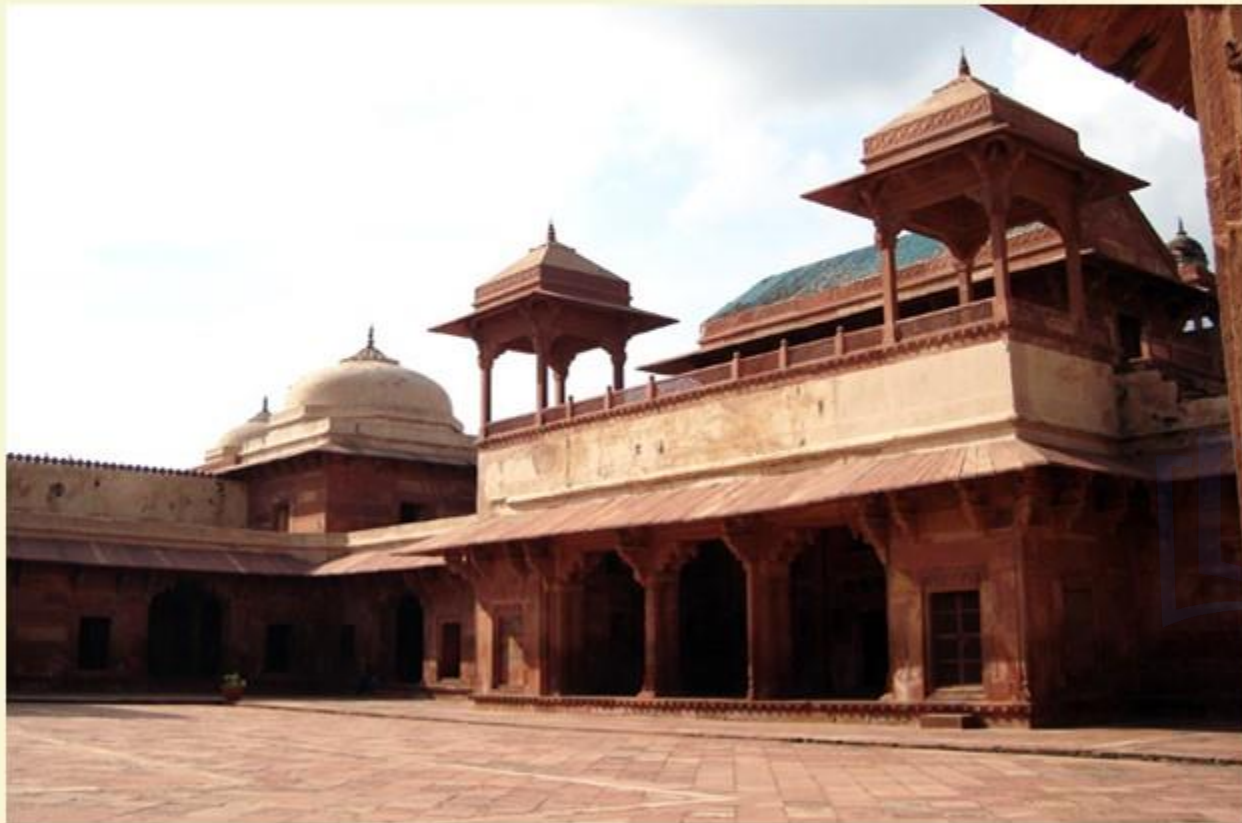
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FATEHPUR SIKRI

3

Some of the important architecture inside the city are:

- Buland Darwaza
- Panch Mahal (used for entertainment and relaxation)
- Jodha Bai's palace
- Salim Chisti's tomb (Akbar was the disciple of Salim Chisti, a sufi saint).
- Ibadat Khana (Akbar used to meet the leaders of different religions here)



JODHA BAI'S PALACE

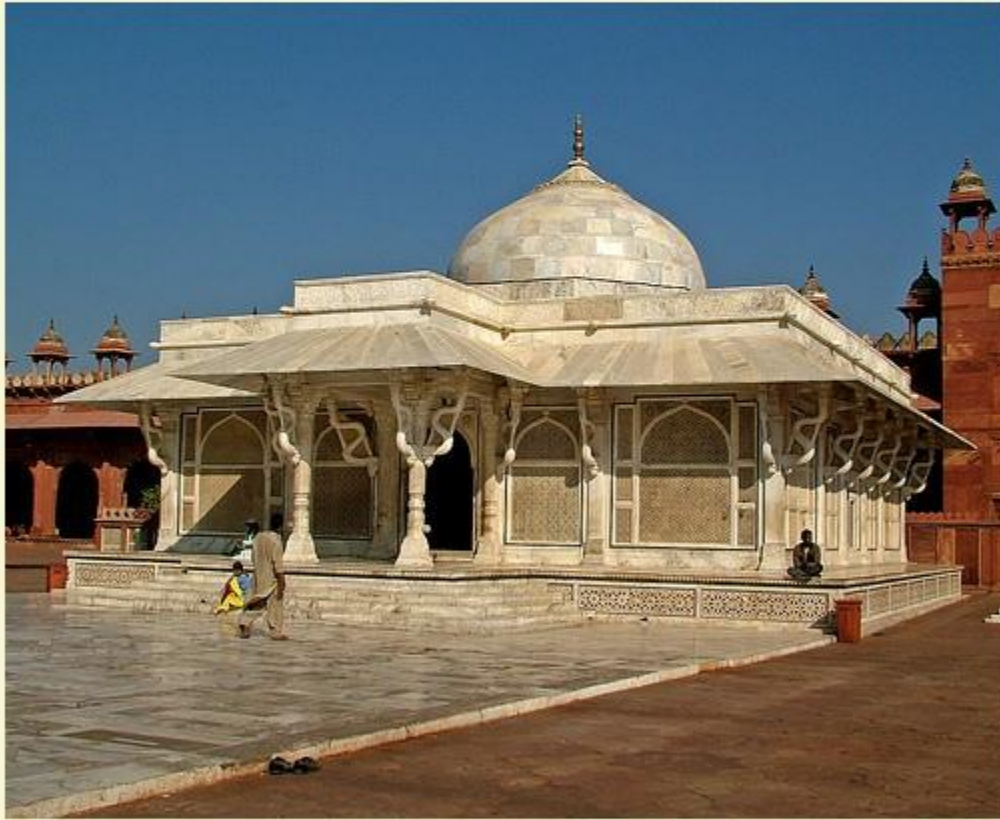
MUGHAL ARCHITECTURE

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AKBAR

2

FATEHPUR SIKRI



TOMB OF SALIM CHISTI



PANCH MAHAL

MUGHAL ARCHITECTURE

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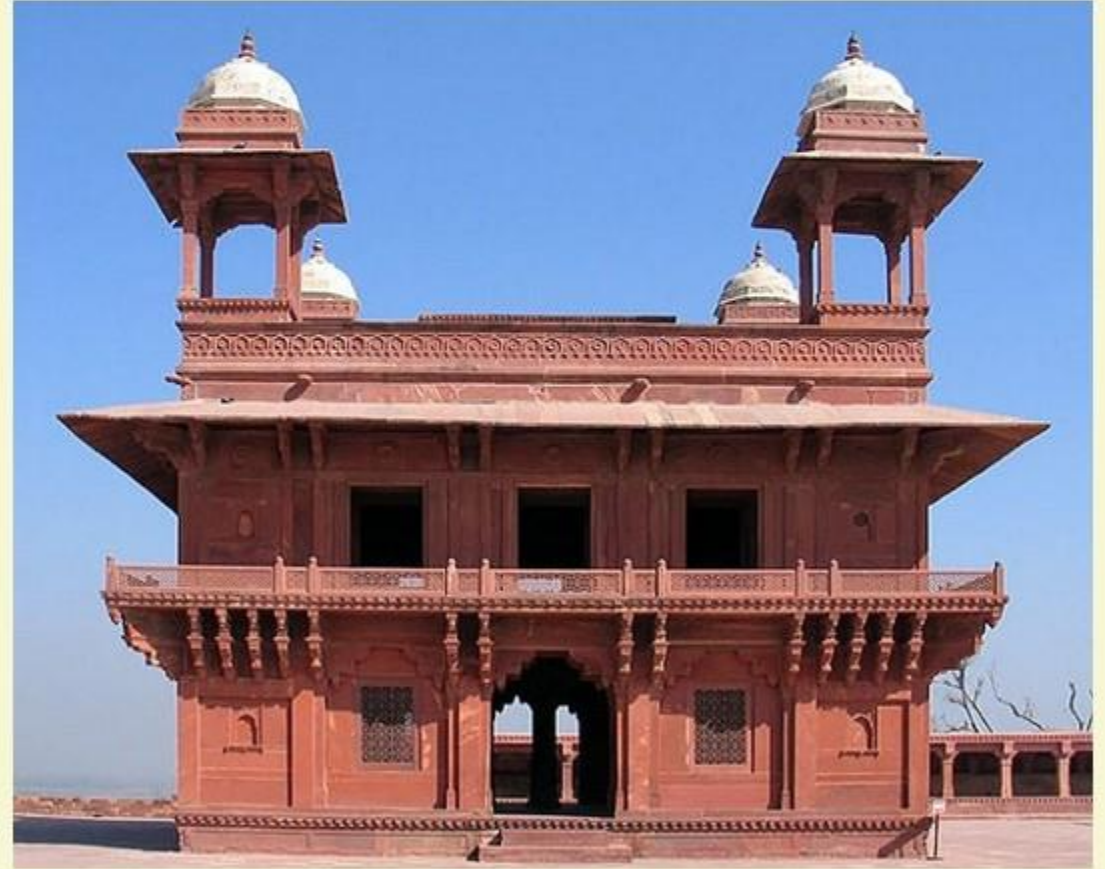
AKBAR

2

FATEHPUR SIKRI



BULAND DARWAZA



IBADAT KHANA

MUGHAL ARCHITECTURE

4

AKBAR

2

FATEHPUR SIKRI



GOVIND DEV TEMPLE IN VRINDAVAN

4

Buland Darwaza is one of the most imposing structures created during the Mughal period while the tomb of Salim Chisti has some of the finest jaali works created.

5

Akbar also built a temple of Govind Dev in Vrindavan.

MUGHAL ARCHITECTURE

5 JAHANGIR



SHALIMAR GARDENS IN KASHMIR

- 1 During the reign of Jahangir, architecture took a back seat as he focused more on paintings and other forms of art.
- 2 However, he oversaw the construction of some noteworthy monuments including Akbar's tomb in Sikandra.
- 3 He also built his own tomb at Lahore.
- 4 Further, he developed a number of gardens during his reign.
Eg: The Shalimar Bagh in Kashmir.
- 5 He also built the Moti Masjid at Lahore.

MUGHAL ARCHITECTURE

5 JAHANGIR



TOMB OF ITMAD-UD-DAULAH

6 During the reign of Jahangir, his wife Noor Jahan also undertook some major construction projects, the tomb of Itmad-ud-daulah, father of Noor Jahan, being an excellent example.

7 It was during this time that white marble became the chief building material, replacing red sandstone which had been used till now.

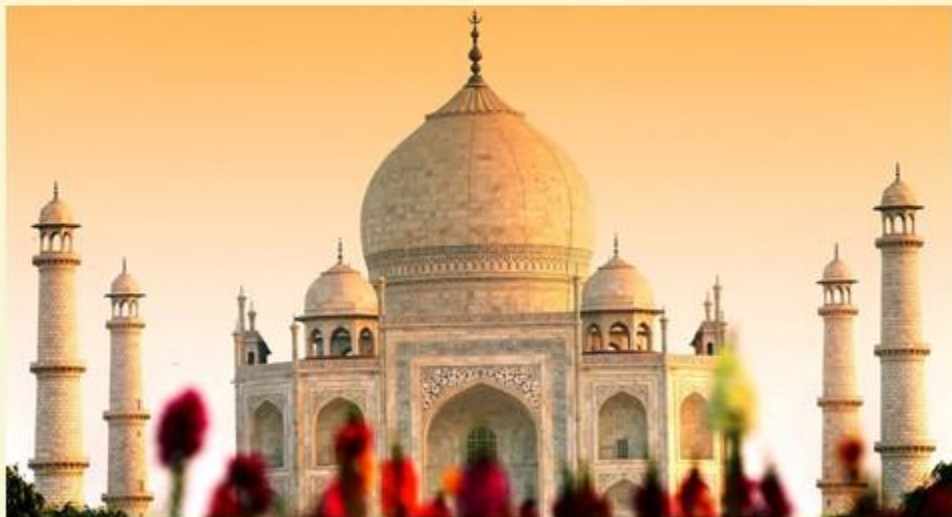
8 The tomb of Itmad-ud-daulah was the first Mughal work made completely of white marble. It also has some of the finest pietra-dura works.

MUGHAL ARCHITECTURE

6 SHAH JAHAN

Under Shah Jahan, Mughal architecture reached its climax. Some of his principal works are described below.

1 TAJ MAHAL



- 1 Taj Mahal is the finest specimen of Mughal architecture, exhibiting the full range of grandeur and opulence.
- 2 It was constructed in the memory of Arzuman Bano Begum or Mumtaz Mahal.
- 3 It had all features of Mughal architecture including the use of calligraphy, pietra dura works, foresightening technique, Charbagh style gardens and the use of water in the premises for decoration.

6 SHAH JAHAN

4 Apart from this, some of the unique features of Taj Mahal are:

- The **jaali work** in Taj Mahal is lace like and extremely fine.
- The carvings on the marble were low relief.



RED FORT

5 Apart from Taj Mahal, Shah Jahan constructed a number of the monuments, gardens and buildings such as:

- **Red Fort** in Delhi
- **Jama Masjid** in Delhi
- **Shalimar Bagh** in Lahore
- **City of Shahjahanabad**

6 Besides such large scale constructions, one of his finest works was the construction of **Peacock Throne** that is one of the finest examples of metal work in this period.

MUGHAL ARCHITECTURE

7 AURANGZEB

- 1 During the reign of Aurangzeb, Mughal architecture declined.
- 2 Being a puritanical, he didn't take an active interest in the pursuit of art and architecture.

8 BAHADUR SHAH ZAFAR

- 1 He was the last of the Mughals to undertake architectural constructions.
- 2 He built **Biwi-ka-Maqbara** in memory of his mother Begum Rabia Durani, wife of Aurangzeb.
- 3 It is situated in Aurangabad and has been described as **a poor imitation of Taj Mahal**. He also built **Zinat Mahal** in Delhi in memory of his wife.

SIKH STYLE OF ARCHITECTURE

During the Mughal period, two style of architecture developed in the region of Rajasthan and Punjab.



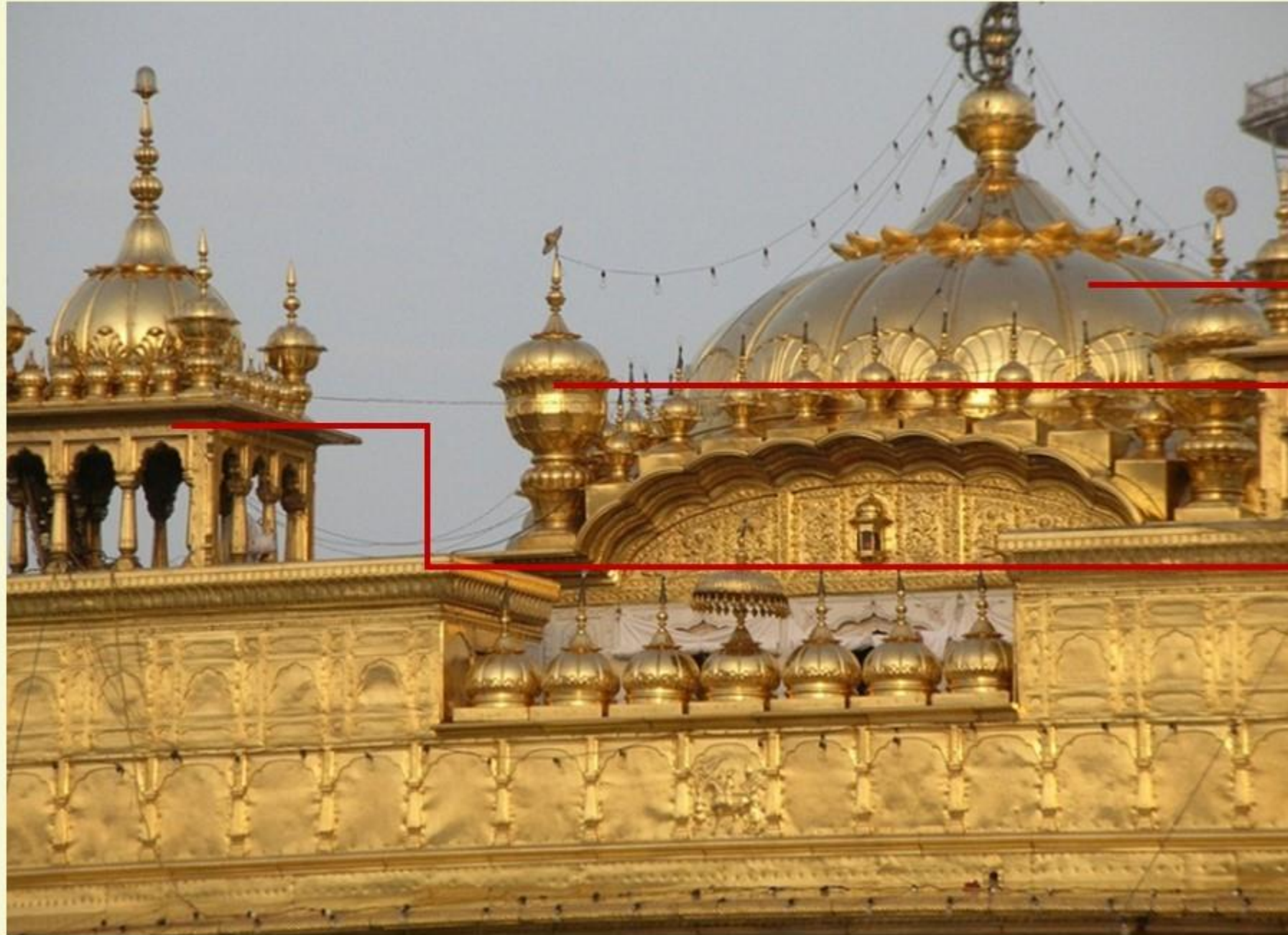
GOLDEN TEMPLE

1 Sikh style of architecture developed in the region of modern day of Punjab. It was heavily influenced by the Mughal style of architecture.

2 Some of the features of the Sikh school are:

- The use of multiple chhatris or kiosks on the top of the construction.
- Use of shallow cornices.
- The buildings had fluted domes, which were generally covered by brass and copper guilds for decoration and support.
- The arches were decorated by the use of numerous foliations.

Eg: Harminder Sahib or Golden temple. It was initiated by Guru Ram Das and completed by Guru Arjun in 1764.



CENTRAL DOME

CUPOLAS

CHHATRIS

RAJPUT STYLE OF ARCHITECTURE



HAWA MAHAL

- 1 The Rajput constructions of the period were also influenced by the Mughal style, but were unique in the size and scope of their constructions.
- 2 They generally undertook the building of imposing palaces and forts.
- 3 Some of the unique features of Rajput architecture are as follows:
 - They introduced the concept of hanging balcony, which were constructed in all shapes and sizes.
 - The cornices were built in the shape of an arch such that the shadow took the shape of a bow.

RAJPUT STYLE OF ARCHITECTURE

The Medieval Period also saw a number of palaces and forts built by the Rajput kings. Some of these are described by following:

FORTS

i JAISALMER FORT

Built in 1156 CE by **Rawal Jaisal**, it is one of the largest fort with a golden hue in the Sam desert (Jaisalmer)

ii KUMBHALGARH FORT

Built in 15th century by **Rana Kumbha**, located in Western Aravalli, the fort has a massive 38 km long wall.

iii CHITTORGARH FORT

It is one of the largest forts in India, located on a hilltop the fort has a history of attacks and seizures, first by **Alauddin Khilji** and later by **Akbar**.

iv ALWAR FORT

Another of the large forts nearly 5 km long and 1.5 km wide, built in 1550 by Hasan Khan Mewati.

v AMER FORT

Near Jaipur, located on a hilltop, covers an area of 4 km.

RAJPUT STYLE OF ARCHITECTURE



HAWA MAHAL

HAWA MAHAL

- This was truly an experiment in architecture.
- The structure is more of a large façade or a giant screen wall of windows which are in the shape of slightly raised pavilions (over fifty in number)
- The objective was to allow the queens (and other women of the palace) a view of the royal processions and everyday street scenes without being themselves observed.

RAJPUT STYLE OF ARCHITECTURE



JANTAR MANTAR

- The Jantar Mantars were five royal astronomical observatories built by Raja Sawai Jai Singh in the 18th Century.
- They were built at Jaipur, Delhi, Varanasi, Mathura and Ujjain.
- The ones at Delhi and Jaipur are much larger and well preserved.
- The observatories contain a number of giant sundials and other instruments for recording the movements and locations of sun, moon and other planets.
- Indeed, these were engineering and architectural marvel.

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